

Figure 10.56 Optical fibers

Applications

Optical fiber system has a number of applications namely, international communication, inter-city communication, data links, plant and traffic control and defense applications.

Merits

i) Fiber cables are very thin and weigh less than copper cables.

ii) This system has much larger band width. This means that its information carrying capacity is larger.

iii) Fiber optic system is immune to electrical interferences.

iv) Fiber optic cables are cheaper than copper cables.

Demerits

i) Fiber optic cables are more fragile when compared to copper wires.

ii) It is an expensive technology.

10.12.3 RADAR AND APPLICATIONS

Radar basically stands for Radio Detection and Ranging System. It is one of the important applications of communication systems and is mainly used to sense, detect, and locate distant objects like aircraft, ships, spacecraft, etc. The angle, range or velocity of the objects that are invisible to the human eye can be determined.

Radar uses electromagnetic waves for communication. The electromagnetic signal is initially radiated into space by an antenna in all directions. When this signal strikes the targeted object, it gets reflected or reradiated in many directions. This reflected (echo) signal is received by the radar antenna which in turn is delivered to the receiver. Then, it is processed and amplified to determine the geographical statistics of the object. The range is determined by calculating the time taken by the signal to travel from RADAR to the target and back.

Applications

Radars find extensive applications in many fields.

i) In military, it is used for locating and detecting the targets.

ii) It is used in navigation systems such as ship borne surface search, air search and missile guidance systems.

iii) Radars are used to measure precipitation rate and wind speed in meteorological observations.

iv) It is employed to locate and rescue people in emergency situations.

10.12.4 MOBILE COMMUNICATION

Mobile communication is used to communicate with others in different locations without the use of any physical connection like wires or cables. It allows the transmission over a wide range of area without the use of the physical link. It enables the people to communicate with each other regardless of a particular location like office, house etc. It also provides communication access to remote areas.

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